

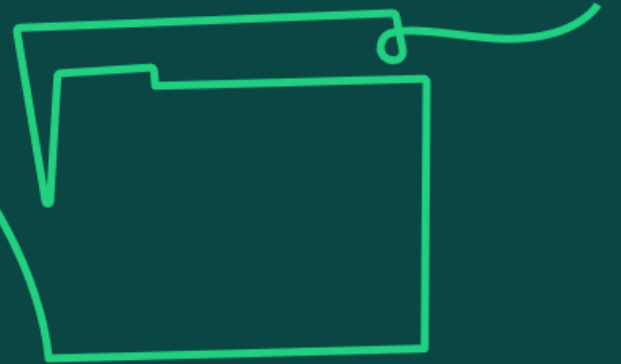
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Quality management

Learning objective:

18. Understand quality management as the ability to ensure that outputs are delivered in accordance with requirements.

18a) Understand what is meant by quality planning, including an understanding of quality indicators and how these relate to the business case.



Quality planning

- Quality planning is the process for establishing quality for a project. It involves taking the defined scope and listing the criteria to be used to validate that the outputs are fit for purpose, and the methods that will be used to do this. This then forms the quality plan, which is approved by the sponsor and wider governance board.
- The quality plan is a key part of the project management plan (PMP) and sets out the work in scope, aligned to the business case, and how it will be assessed. It includes regulations, standards, specifications and the agreed acceptance criteria. This then provides guidance to the project team as it answers the question what does good look like?
- The quality plan guides the planning of quality control and assurance activities that also confirm that outputs meet requirements. All these activities require resources and will influence tasks on the project that need to be estimated and planned into the schedule and cost.
- Finally, getting stakeholder agreement for the quality plan supports a successful handover on project completion. It ensures that what is being delivered by the project team achieves the outcomes of the business case and to the required standards.

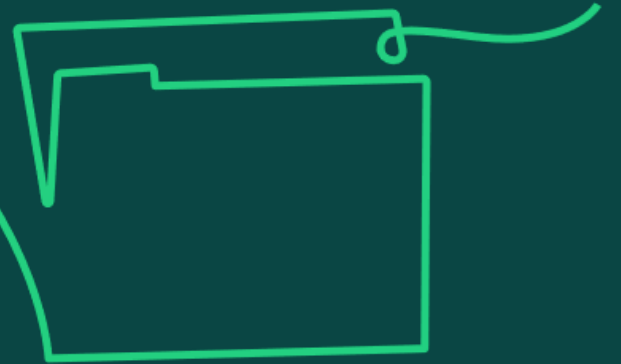
Quality plan

- The contents of the Quality Plan could include:
 - Project Deliverables and the Acceptance Criteria (Pass/Fail metrics)
 - Quality Standards, Policies, Systems of the host organization and other bodies
 - Relevant Quality Tools and techniques
 - Quality Control Processes and Procedures
 - Quality Assurance Processes and Procedures
 - Organisation, Roles & Responsibilities
 - Reporting requirements



Photo credit: Alejandro Escamilla

18b) Knowledge of how quality control techniques are used to determine whether success criteria are met.



Quality management

- Quality control is verifying compliance of the output to requirements.
- Quality assurance is providing confidence that the right processes and methods have been used to deliver it.
- When using an iterative life cycle, acceptance criteria will be defined for each time period, and then will also be verified for the final product, once the project is delivered, to confirm the acceptance criteria have been met for the overarching outputs.
- If a project is part of a programme, some quality requirements may be planned and controlled at programme level.



Regulatory Quality Standards
And Policies

Organisational Quality Standards
And Policies

Quality Planning

Focus is on HOW we deliver the quality
Expected by the Stakeholders

Standards, Policies, Procedures, Tools &
Techniques
Responsibilities
Quality Control & Assurance approaches
Reporting

Agreed ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Quality Control

Focus is on ensuring the products
of the project meet the agreed
Acceptance Criteria. Ensures
outputs are Fit for Purpose

Done inside the Project Team
(helped by Users)

Starts in Deployment as it needs
outputs to review, then goes
into Transition

Quality Assurance

Focus is on giving confidence to
stakeholders that the project is
being well managed

Compliance with agreed
processes

Done from outside the Project
Starts in Definition, carries on into
Deployment, Transition



Quality control versus quality assurance

Quality control

- Consists of inspection, measurement and testing to confirm project outputs meet acceptance criteria defined during quality planning.
- Focused on finding problems to stop them from being passed onto the end customer.
- Can be performed by a member of the project team.
- To be effective, the test plans agreed during quality planning need to be managed through change control, so any amendments are agreed and communicated.
- Test plans include aspects such as:
 - sample size of tests
 - test protocols including resources required
 - independent performance or witnessing of tests
- To start when physical outputs are delivered to be tested against.
- Outputs are checked against degree of conformance to the requirements and acceptance criteria. If non-conformance, decisions need to be made on what action is needed.
- Quality control as a process will provide a pass or fail result; there is nothing in-between.

Quality assurance

- Looks to build in quality using standard processes and procedures supported by training and feedback.
- Looks to maintain stakeholder confidence that a project has been delivered in the right way.
- Is performed by people independent to the project (eg Programme, Internal Audit, Corporate Quality Team, external bodies).
- To be effective, a framework with supporting documentation on how to do things and methods to use needs to be in place as standard practice.
- To be applied as soon as the project commences management activity (Definition onwards).
- In the event a deviation to organisationally set standards is identified, a decision will need to be made on what action is needed, by the relevant corporate governance board.
- Quality assurance as a process may not be followed fully, yet still deliver an acceptable output, but having an independent QA function will increase the chance of success.